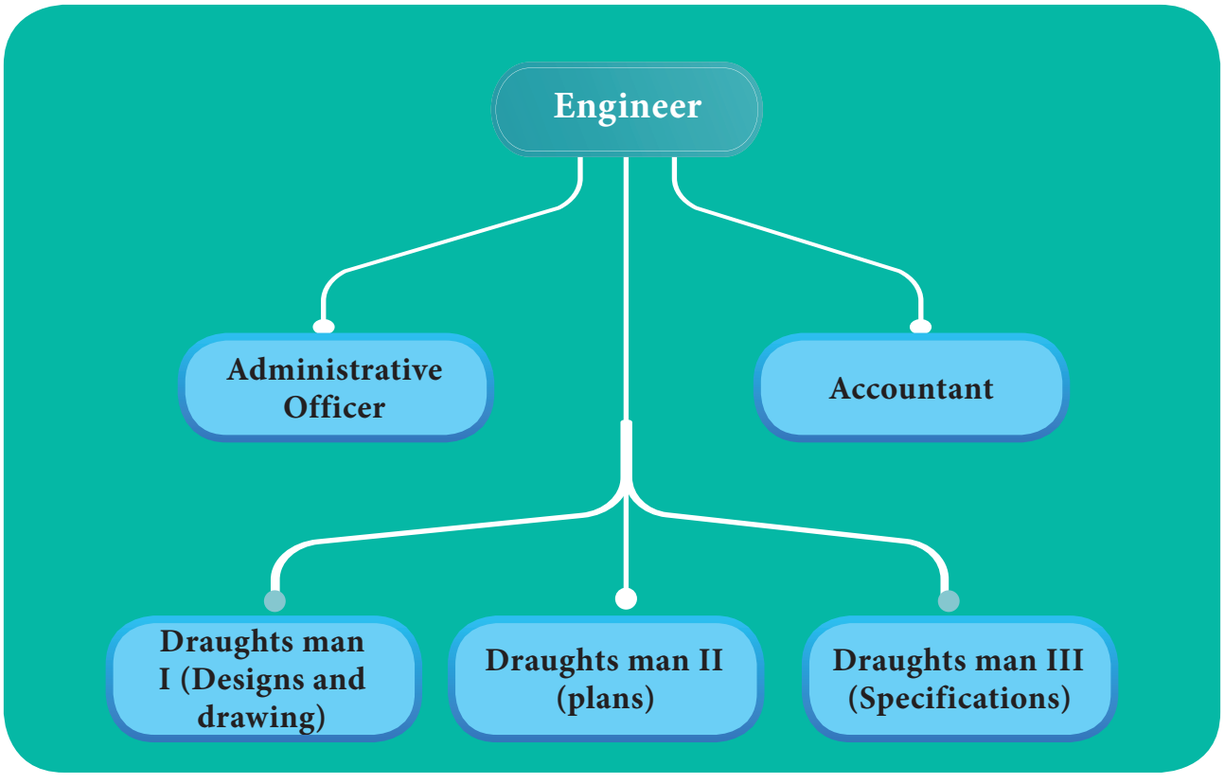


Figure 3.7 Line and staff relationship in an organisation

undertake specialized investigation of each problem - situation, for which they may not always be competent.

- **Training of young staff executives:** A line and staff organisation offers an opportunity to young staff executives to acquire expertise in their respective fields of activity.

Demerits of Line and Staff Organisation

- **Confusion:** It may not always be possible to determine the pattern of authority relationships between line and staff executives, which might create confusion.
- **Expertise not aided by authority:** Staff executives may be experts in their fields of activity but they only have an advisory role. They lack authority to implement their advice.
- **Centralisation:** In a line and staff organisation, line executives alone have the power to make and execute decisions. Thus it tends towards centralization of authority in a few hands.

3.10 Functional organization

A functional organisation is one where the work is organised on the basis of specialization. In such an organisation, each specialist conveys his instructions direct to the line personnel, rather than through a formal chain of command. This type of organisation was devised by F.W. Taylor, the founder of the scientific management.

The various functional departments in such an organisation provide various services to the line mangers in respect of work study, maintenance, purchase of materials, control of stocks, quality control etc. In the absence of service provided by these departments, the line managers will be required to perform these functions on their own.

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